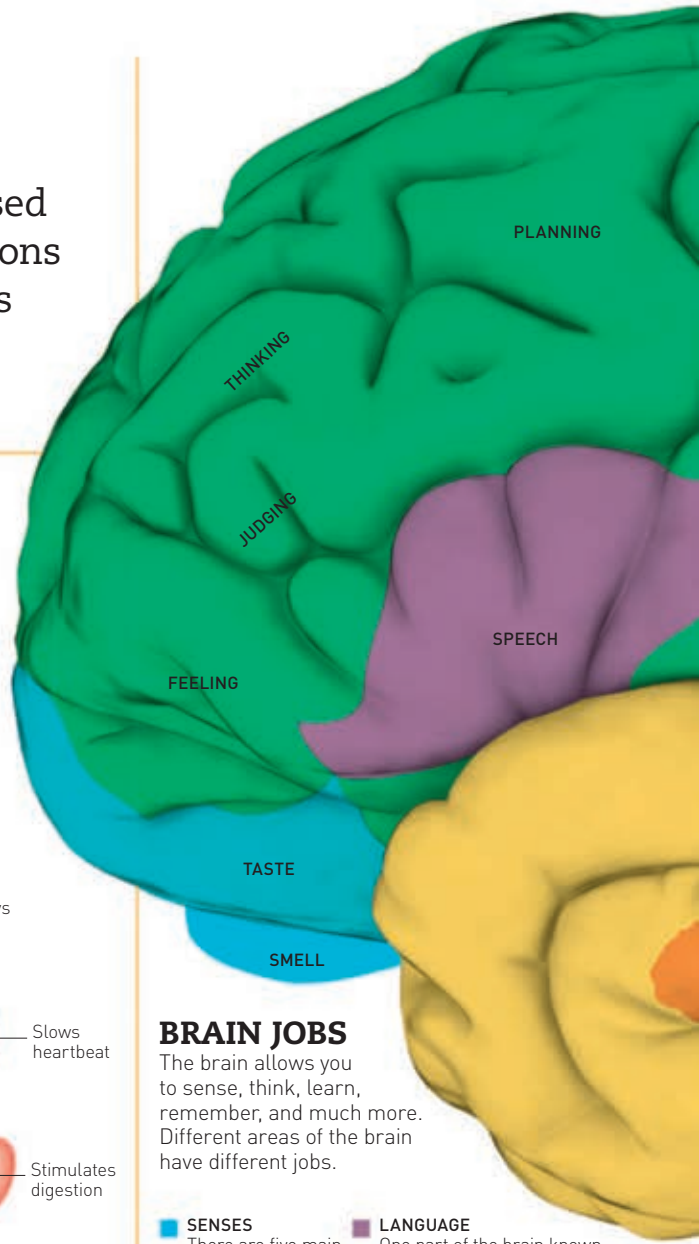
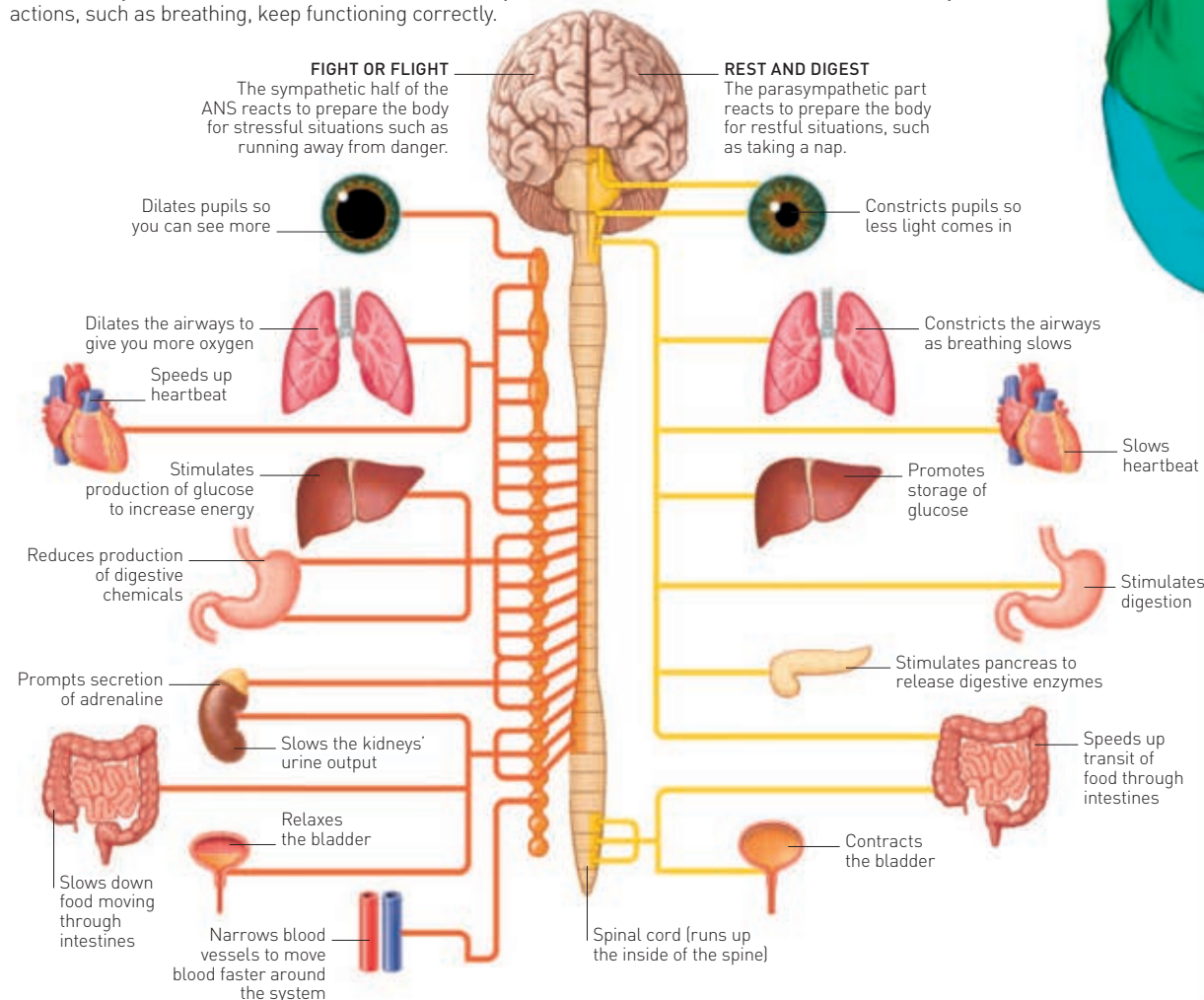


The brain

The brain is the most complex organ in the body. Safely encased inside the skull, it controls our actions and all the body functions that keep us alive. It also monitors the world around us, stores our memories, and enables us to plan for the future.

NERVOUS SYSTEM

The brain is linked to the rest of the body through a network of nerves, known as the nervous system. This network acts as a kind of information highway, carrying messages between the brain and the body. Part of the system, known as the autonomic nervous system (ANS), makes sure all our "automatic" body actions, such as breathing, keep functioning correctly.



BRAIN JOBS

The brain allows you to sense, think, learn, remember, and much more. Different areas of the brain have different jobs.

SENSES

There are five main sense areas in the brain. They process the signals from the sense organs – eyes, ears, skin, tongue, and nose.

MEMORIES

The hippocampus is where your brain makes and stores memories.

THOUGHTS

The large area known as the prefrontal cortex processes your thoughts. It turns them into plans, judgements, and ideas, and also helps you to understand other people's feelings.

LANGUAGE

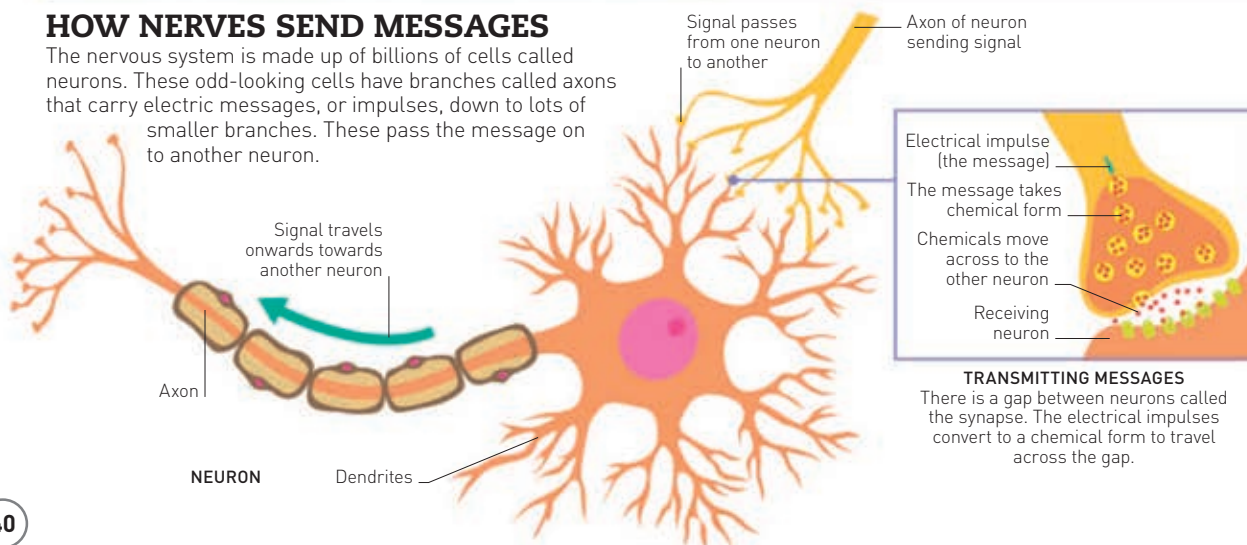
One part of the brain known as Broca's area controls your speech. Two other parts, known as Geschwind's territory and Wernicke's area, help you to learn and understand language.

MOVEMENT

This part of the brain is called the motor cortex and it sends signals to your muscles to tell them to move your body.

HOW NERVES SEND MESSAGES

The nervous system is made up of billions of cells called neurons. These odd-looking cells have branches called axons that carry electric messages, or impulses, down to lots of smaller branches. These pass the message on to another neuron.



BRAIN AREAS

The human brain has many different parts, but it can be divided into three main areas. The large cerebrum deals with thoughts, language, and behaviour. The limbic system processes emotions, and the cerebellum coordinates movement.



HUMAN BRAIN

The human brain has lots of wrinkles, which hold all its information. If the surface of your brain was unfolded, it would be more than twice as big.